
Let's Talk About
CHICKENPOX

What is chickenpox?

Chickenpox is an illness caused by the varicella-zoster virus. It brings on an itchy rash with small fluid-filled blisters. The virus spreads easily to people who haven't had the disease or haven't gotten the chickenpox vaccine.

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The chickenpox vaccine is a safe way to prevent this illness and the other health issues that can happen with it. Chickenpox used to be a widespread condition, but today the vaccine protects children from it.

What are the symptoms?



The itchy rash from chickenpox appears 10 to 21 days after you're exposed to the varicella-zoster virus. The rash often lasts about 5 to 10 days. Other symptoms that may appear 1 to 2 days before the rash include:

- Fever.
- Not wanting to eat.
- Headache.
- Tiredness and a feeling of not being well.

The Three Phases:

Once the chickenpox rash appears, it goes through three phases:

- Raised bumps called papules, which break out over a few days.
- Small fluid-filled blisters called vesicles, which form in about one day and then break and leak.
- Crusts and scabs, which cover the broken blisters. The scabs most often fall off in 1 to 2 weeks.

When to see a doctor?

If you think you or your child may have chickenpox, contact your healthcare professional's office. To keep from infecting people in the waiting room, tell the staff that you think you or your child may have chickenpox.